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Registration No.

46104254

VISIONIAS

Classroom Assignment Sheet

Assignment Code

153222

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Name: JAYANT KUMAR

Subject: History Batch: RB33 Submission Date: 19/6/2026

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Question - How do you justify that 18th century India was beset with the fragmented polity and what were the repercussions of it, Discuss.

The death of Aurangzeb in 1707 commenced the disintegration of Mughal India alongside into regional and successor states alongside British consolidation in India.

"Fragmented Polity" - The identity of 18th century India

- ① Despite the political instability in Mughal Empire between 1707-1719, initiatives like "The Royal Farman of 1717" expedited British consolidation & expansion in India.
- ② Decisive battles like "The Battle of Kheda" led to the establishment of successor state-Hydrabad - removing one of the powerful provinces from Mughal India.
- ③ Foreign invasions by Nadir Shah, Ahmad Shah Abdali led to the loss of Mughal autonomy over Punjab and Multan.
- ④ Battle of Plassey, 1757 giving removed Bengal from Mughal India and led to the creation of

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Sponsored Nawabs in Bengal with nominal authority.
⑤ Battle of Buxar, 1764 making Awadh as the subsidiary alliance of British via treaty of Allahbad.

⑥ The political ambitions of European powers such as French and British to install their candidates in Carnatic led resulted in British being the sole colonial power in India by 1764 through a very decisive battle - Battle of Wandiwash, 1760.

British East India Company played a vital role in fragmenting the polity of 18th century India, not by controlling the political positions but by making the rulers "Stamp" "Rubber Stamps".

⑦ The fragmentation was not merely political but also financial through administrative inefficiencies like Jizya tax, Izaredari, granting chauth & Sardeshmukhi to Marathas. In addition to these, foreign invasions looting prized positions like peacock throne, battles like Third Battle of Panipat, 1761 drained Mughal wealth.

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Excellent						
Good						
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Question -

Repercussions of disintegration of India in 18th cent

- ① Starting of "flight of Gold" from the once glorious Golden bird - India.
- ② Allowed British to take control of the fragmented territory by defeating one regional power at a time.
- ③ British started its clever annexation policy through "Subsidiary Alliance System".

The fragmentation of 18th century India was not decided but became "destined" due to many factors such as military, social, political, religious.

The European powers took advantage of the "already declining & fragmenting India" because to break something, it must be disintegrated but if it is already disintegrated - then it is just a matter of time.